

Other Forms, Other Lives

By ODA.Dream

Introduction

In contemporary society, people with disabilities are often perceived as "inconvenient" — we avoid them, feel embarrassed, scared, or express pity. This leads to their isolation and loneliness. However, if we look at them differently, they could become our "aliens" and "gurus" — those who open new horizons for perceiving the world. Their consciousness is adapted to a different reality, and this makes them unique teachers, capable of showing us new ways of understanding life.

Project Goals and Objectives

Goal: To reveal the beauty of the inner world of people with disabilities through art and science, thereby changing society's perception.

Objectives:

- To create a series of artworks based on the creativity of children with developmental disabilities.
- To capture the brain rhythms of participants during the creative process using neurobiological technologies.
- To organize an interactive exhibition where visitors can compare their brain rhythms with those of the participants.
- To tell the stories of these individuals to showcase their uniqueness and inspire society to reconsider its attitudes toward disability.

Methods and Technologies

- Neurobiology: Using EEG (electroencephalography) to record the brain activity of participants during their creative process.
- Art: Creating visual, sound, and interactive pieces based on the brain activity data.
- Interactivity: Exhibition visitors will have the chance to record their own brain rhythms and compare them with those of the project participants.

Relevance

This project combines art, science, and social issues, offering a new perspective on people with disabilities. It not only showcases their creative potential but also helps society see them as equals, rather than objects of pity or fear. This is especially important in the modern world, where inclusivity and diversity are becoming key values.

Rationale for Residency Participation

The residency at Tabakalera offers a unique opportunity to realize this project in collaboration with experts in art, science, and technology. It is the perfect place to develop and test interactive installations, as well as to present the project on an international scale at the Sónar Festival 2025.

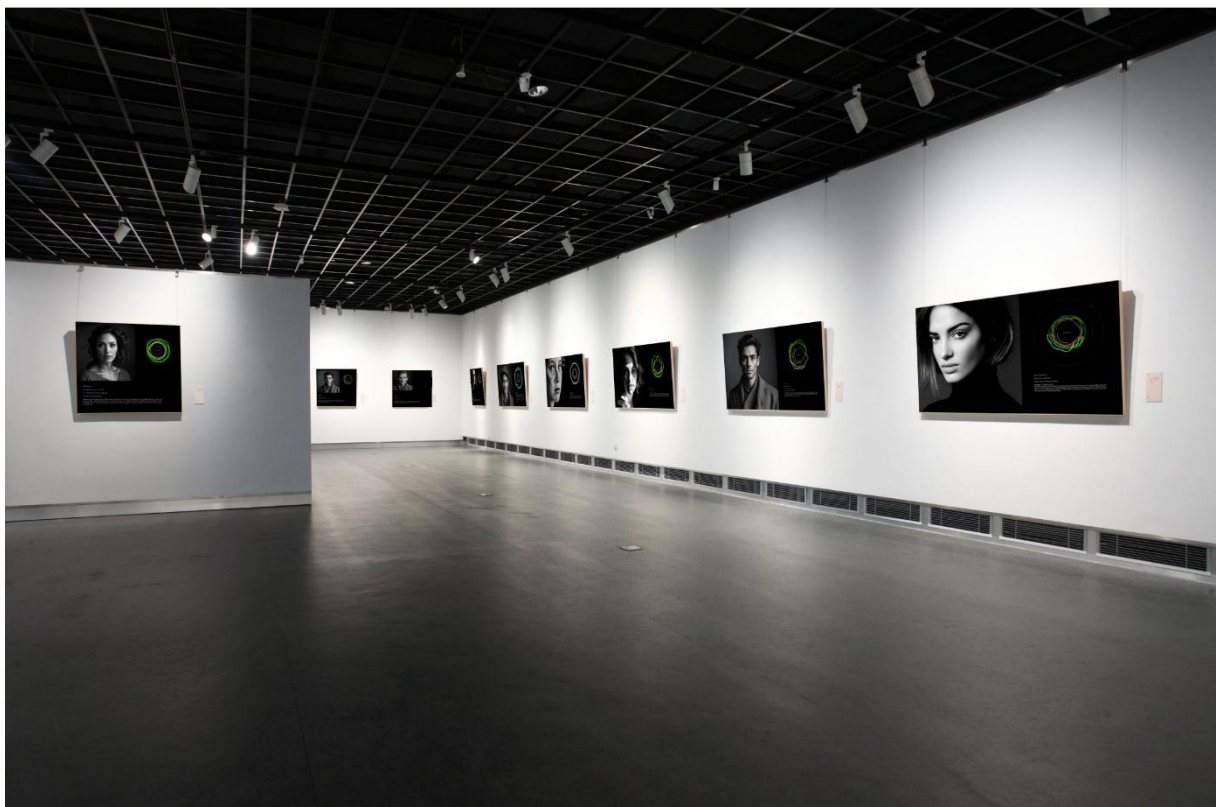
Expected Results

- An interactive exhibition featuring visual, sound, and neurobiological installations.
- Publication of project materials at the Sónar Festival 2025.
- Changing the perception of people with disabilities through art and science.

Visitor Experience

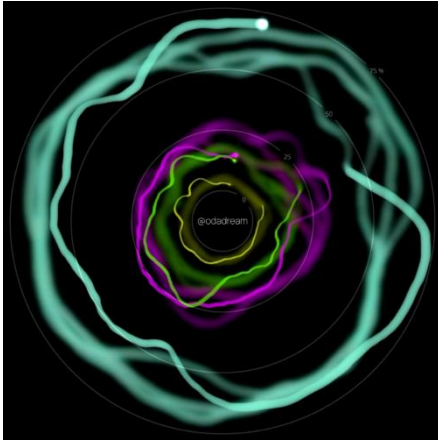


Visitors wear Muse Headbands to record brain activity, receiving a personal Neuromandala video on their phones. They explore character cards featuring portraits, bios, and Neuromandalas, comparing their own rhythms with those of the characters. This creates a unique dialogue, fostering empathy and redefining perceptions of disability through art and neuroscience.



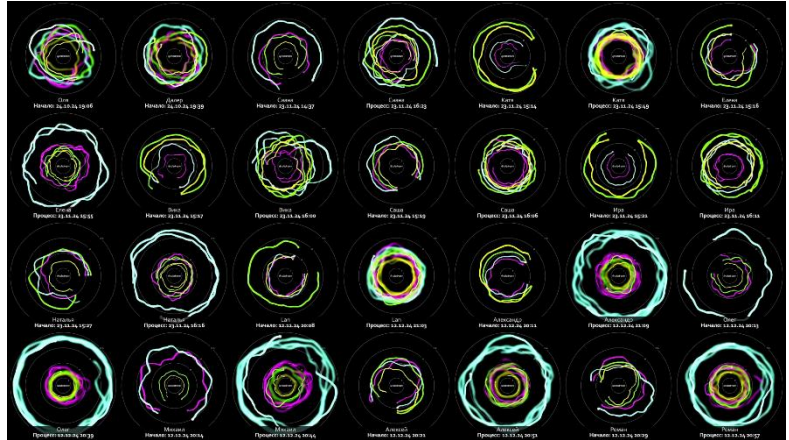
Previous Works

1. Neuromandala



A visualization of a five-minute recording of a person's brain activity while listening to the gong music of Nikolai Lgovsky. This project explores how sound influences psychophysiological states, creating a graphical trace of internal experiences.

2. Mind Grid



A comparison of brain activity between two groups of people listening to live singing by Siana Lik and gong music by Nikolai Lgovsky. The project visualizes the dynamics of state changes under the influence of different auditory stimuli.

3. Neuromandala Diffusion



A visualization of brain rhythms combined with the generation of futuristic cityscapes through AI. Participants associated brain states (theta, alpha, beta, gamma) with specific images such as "city of hustle" or "city of science."

4. Mind Grid Diffusion



A neuro-portrait of the III Forum on Urban Development and Territories, "Battle for a Billion." The project captured collective associations and sensations of the participants, represented in a unified visual form.

A video of the work can be [viewed at the link](#)

About us

ODA.Dream is a family duo consisting of Olga and Daler Arabov from Moscow, Russia. They specialize in media design, neuroscience popularization, and mindfulness practices. The duo created the unique brain visualization technology "Neuromandala," which forms the foundation for their installations, performances, immersive lectures, and neuro-practices.

Mission

ODA.Dream aims to create new communication forms that deepen self-awareness and encourage open, honest interaction between people. They seek to unlock individuals' potential through technologies that enable awareness and management of internal states, fostering a more conscious and harmonious technopositive society.

Technologies

A key part of their work involves biofeedback, a method that measures psychophysiological processes like brain activity, pulse, and muscle tone through devices. Results are displayed through graphs or audio signals, helping individuals recognize and manage their internal states.

One of their innovative technologies, Neuromandala, visualizes temporary brain activity changes, displaying alpha, beta, gamma, and theta waves. This technology allows people to not only become aware of their psychophysiological states but also use them for personal transformation. Neuromandala was developed with the involvement of specialists from Russia and abroad, including Neurobotics and neurophysiologists from HSE, MSU, and Skoltech.

Achievements

Over the years, the duo has researched over 15 psychopractices, measuring over 3,000 hours of psychophysiological activity, and developed more than 20 products and services. ODA.Dream collaborates with Neurobotics, Interaxon Inc., and other partners in neuroscience and biofeedback.

Philosophy

ODA.Dream is not just about developing technologies; the duo believes in the possibility of societal transformation through innovative self-awareness and interaction methods. Their practices and products are gateways to a new world where everyone can explore and manage their inner state, interacting with others on a deep level of empathy and honesty.



Budget

Expense Item	Amount (€)	Comments
Transfer	1,600–2,000	Airfare (Moscow – San Sebastián) for 2 adults and 1 child. Transfer from the airport for a taxi.
Accommodation	3,360–5,040	Rental for 42 days. Possible discounts for long-term stay.
Food	3,360	For 2 adults and 1 child
Equipment	1,800–3,200	Rental of neuro-headsets, phones, screens/projectors, and purchase of Raspberry Pi and Mikrotik access points. Need to clarify with organizers what equipment is already available on-site.
Additional Expenses	1,050–1,400	Insurance, visa, office supplies, transport, unforeseen expenses.
Total Budget	11,170–14,000	Total for all expenses.

Preliminary Work Schedule

- April 28 – May 10: Preparation of equipment and materials.
- May 11 – May 20: Working with participants, recording brain activity.
- May 21 – May 30: Creation of installations based on the collected data.
- May 31 – June 8: Testing and exhibition preparation.